

Lesson 16

Making Requests and Offering Help



Video

MAKING REQUESTS IN THE WORKPLACE

1. What are the effective ways of making requests at work?
2. What phrases can you use in making more formal and polite requests? Give an example.
3. What way can you use for a simple and quick way to give command or order? Give an example.
4. What phrase can you use to soften requests? Give an example.



Role-Play

Scenario: David is working on a project with Pia, and he needs some assistance. Pia is busy with her own tasks, but you'd like to ask for their help.

David: Hi, Pia. How does your schedule look today?

Pia: Well, I am reviewing my report before I submit it. Why?

David: I'm working on the project report and I'm having some trouble with data analysis. **Would you mind** helping me out?

Pia: *Let me know how I can help.* What specifically do you need assistance with?

David: I'm having trouble understanding the trends in data. *I'd really appreciate it if* you could look and offer some insights.

Pia: Okay, I can take a look. *If it's not too much trouble,* can you help me with my task? I need someone to review my report before submission.

David: Absolutely, I'd be happy to help. Let's trade favors – you help me with your data analysis, and I'll review your report.

Role-Play Analysis

1. How did David approach Pia for his request? What was his request?
2. What polite expression did David use for his request?
3. Does Pia sound like she really wanted to do the request of David? Why or why not?
4. Did Pia also make requests from David? What was her request?
5. Were the requests for each other clear? Why or why not?



Making Requests & Offering Help: Phrases

1. *Could you please + Base Verb*

Example:

- Could you please help?
- Could you please send it?

2. *Would you mind + V_ing*

Example:

- Would you mind helping me?
- Would you mind calling the client?

3. *Would it be possible to...* – used to make a polite request and to show consideration for the other's time and availability.

Example:

- ***Would it be possible to*** get your feedback on this report?
- ***Would it be possible*** for you to help me with this task?

4. *Let me know if you need any help.* – used to offer assistance or support.

Example: ***Let me know if you need any help*** with this project.

5. *If it's not too much trouble...* – used to acknowledge the other person's time and effort.

Example: Would you mind reviewing this document if it's not too much trouble?

6. I'd really appreciate it if... – used to show gratitude and appreciation in advance.

Example: *I'd really appreciate it if* you could review this document before I submit it.

7. Let me know how I can help. – used to help, support, and willingness to help.

Example: *Let me know how I can help* you with this project.



Practice 1

Instructions: Match the requests with the most suitable offers of help.

Requests

1. _____ I need to finish this report by tomorrow.
2. _____ moving to a new apartment on Saturday.
3. _____ I have a lot of work to do today.
4. _____ I need to pick up my dry cleaning.
5. _____ I'm struggling with this project.

Offers of Help

- A. Would it be possible to help me with the heavy lifting?
- B. Let me know if you need any help with proofreading.
- C. If it's not too much trouble, could you give me a ride to the dry cleaner?
- D. I'd really appreciate it if you could review my project and provide feedback.
- E. Let me know how can I help with your workload today.



Practice 2

Instructions:

Team up with a partner and practice asking for input by making statement and then asking your partner for the appropriate ways in making requests.

STATEMENT	APPROPRIATE WAYS IN MAKING REQUESTS
1. You need help reviewing a report. (formal and polite)	
2. You need the presentation material. (formal and polite)	
3. Sign on the bottom. (informal and imperative structure)	
4. Write your name at the top. (informal imperative structure)	
5. Meet me at 9 AM instead of 10 AM.(softening request)	
6. Finish the report a day earlier. (softening request)	



Production

ROLE-PLAY: MAKING REQUEST AND OFFERING HELP

- Work in pairs.
- Each pair will be provided with one of the role-play scenarios below.
- One member will take on the role of the person making a request, while the other will be the person offering help.
- Act out the role-play using polite phrases from the vocabulary.
- If time permits, switch roles and practice with another scenario.

SCENARIO

Scenario 1: The Report Deadline

- **Requester:** You need to finish a project report by the end of the day but are struggling with some sections.
- **Helper:** You have already completed your own report and can offer help with proofreading and giving feedback.

Scenario 2: Moving Day

- **Requester:** You are moving to a new apartment this weekend and need help with lifting heavy boxes.
- **Helper:** You're willing to help with heavy lifting, but you also have some errands to run that day. Offer to help if you can work out a time.

Scenario 3: Preparing for a Presentation

- **Requester:** You're preparing for a big presentation and need assistance with practicing your delivery.
- **Helper:** You have experience with presentations and can offer to listen and provide constructive feedback, but you need to finish a project first.

Scenario 4: Running Errands

- **Requester:** You need to pick up medication from the pharmacy and also need to go grocery shopping but are short on time.
- **Helper:** You can offer to pick up the medication for Jamie while you're out, but ask if Jamie can handle the grocery shopping.

Scenario 5: Team Project

- **Requester:** You are struggling with certain aspects of a team project and need help from a teammate.
- **Helper:** You're available to help and suggest meeting after class to discuss the project in detail.

Discussion:

1. How did you feel when making requests? Was it easy or challenging for you?
2. What strategies did you use to ensure your requests were polite and effective?
3. Did you find it easier to make requests or to offer help? Why?
4. What phrases or expressions did you find particularly useful during the role-play?
5. How did your partner respond to your requests? Did they seem willing to help?



Wrap-up

Share your thoughts

“Don’t be afraid to ask questions, Don’t be afraid to ask for help when you need it. I do that everyday. Asking for help isn’t a sign of weakness, it’s a sign of strength. It shows you have the courage to admit when you don’t know something and learn something new.”

- Barack Obama [the 44th president of the United States (2009–2017) and the first African American to hold the office]



Homework

Practice writing polite and effective email requests for help and assistance.

Send email requests to your trainer’s email address.